

KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569-88

Assessment Question: From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home				
L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain				
L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88				
L4: KT2.4: The Armada				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for, and the significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569–70).
- ☐ Analyse the key features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- ☐ Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. Explain why the Northern Earls' Rebellion (1569-70) posed a significant danger to Elizabeth I. (12 marks)

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal blue lines across its entire width. The paper is otherwise completely empty, with no margins, text, or other markings.

2. Describe one feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571). (2 marks) Describe one feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571). (2 marks)

3. Describe one feature of the Throckmorton Plot (1583). (2 marks) Describe one feature of the Throckmorton Plot (1583). (2 marks)

5. Explain why the Babington Plot (1586) led to the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots. (12 marks)

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 horizontal blue lines spaced evenly across the page, typical of standard notebook paper. The lines are thin and light blue, set against a plain white background. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

7. 'Walsingham and the use of spies was the main reason for the significance of Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

[illegible]

8. 'Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne was the main cause of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

[illegible]

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex roots of the Anglo-Spanish conflict, focusing on religious, political, and commercial rivalry.
- ☐ Explain the significance of English involvement in the Netherlands, specifically the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch.
- ☐ Analyse the causes and Philip II's strategic plan for the Spanish Armada.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: In what year was Mary, Queen of Scots executed at Fotheringhay Castle?

2. Define: What is an 'agent provocateur'?

3. Explain: How did the 1570 Papal Bull impact Philip II's view of his duty towards Elizabeth?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the Babington Plot.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Privateer | Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) | Galleon | Fireships

Your Sentence:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. Explain why relations between England and Spain declined in the years 1568-1585. (12 marks)

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

2. "The threat from Catholics at home was more serious than the threat from Spain in the years 1569-1588." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain, focusing on religious shifts, the Genoese Loan, the assassination of William of Orange, and the Treaty of Joinville.
- ☐ Analyse the significance of English direct involvement in the Netherlands through the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- ☐ Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Exam Practice

2. 'The actions of Robert Dudley were the main reason for deteriorating relations with Spain in the years 1585–88.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: KT2.4: The Armada

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex, overlapping reasons why Philip II finally decided to launch the Spanish Armada in 1588.
- ☐ Analyse the Spanish invasion plans, highlighting the critical logistical flaws from the very beginning.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the English victory, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.
- ☐ Explain the immense domestic and international consequences of the Armada's defeat.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Exam Practice

[illegible]

2. "English naval tactics were the main reason for the defeat of the Spanish Armada." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
